Course notes

Vocabulary and operations

Definition · Matrix. A *matrix* of size $n \times p$ is an array of real numbers with n rows and p columns. The entry in row i and column j of A is written a_{ij}. An $n \times 1$ matrix is a *column* matrix, a $1 \times p$ matrix a *row* matrix, an $n \times n$ matrix a *square* matrix of order n. The *identity* matrix I_n has 1s on the diagonal and 0s elsewhere; the *zero* matrix has only 0s. A square matrix is *diagonal* if its entries off the diagonal are zero.

Definition · Sum, product by a real number, product. For A and B of the same size and k real, $A + B$ and kA are computed entry by entry.

If A has size $n \times p$ and B has size $p \times q$, the product AB is the $n \times q$ matrix with entries

$$c_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^{p} a_{ik} b_{kj} = a_{i1} b_{1j} + a_{i2} b_{2j} + \cdots + a_{ip} b_{pj}.$$

Example 1 · A product. $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ -1 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 4 & -2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1\times 0 + 2 \times 4 & 1 \times 1 + 2 \times (-2) \\ -1 \times 0 + 3 \times 4 & -1 \times 1 + 3 \times (-2) \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 8 & -3 \\ 12 & -7 \end{pmatrix}$.

Property · Rules of computation. When the products are defined: $(AB)C = A(BC)$, $A(B + C) = AB + AC$, $(A + B)C = AC + BC$, $(kA)B = k(AB)$, and $AI_n = I_n A = A$ for A square of order n.

Watch out.

1. In general $AB \neq BA$; consequently $(A + B)^2 = A^2 + AB + BA + B^2$, and not $A^2 + 2AB + B^2$.
2. A product can be zero without either factor being zero: $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

Powers

Definition · Powers of a square matrix. For A square of order n, let $A^0 = I_n$ and $A^{k+1} = A^k A$ for every natural number k.

Method · Conjecture, then prove by induction. For $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, we compute $A^2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $A^3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ and conjecture $A^k = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & k \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. This is true for $k = 0$; if it is true for k, then $A^{k+1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & k \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & k+1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$.

Key point · Diagonal matrix. If D is diagonal with diagonal entries $d_1, \ldots, d_n$, then D^k is diagonal with entries $d_1^k, \ldots, d_n^k$.

Inverse and systems

Definition · Invertible matrix. A square matrix A of order n is *invertible* if there is a matrix B such that $AB = BA = I_n$. This matrix is unique; it is written A^{-1}.

Property · Inverse of a matrix of order 2. Let $A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$. The matrix A is invertible if and only if $ad - bc \neq 0$, and then

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc} \begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}.$$

The number $ad - bc$ is the *determinant* of A, written $\det A$.

Proof. Let $M = \begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$. Computation gives $AM = MA = (ad - bc)I_2$. If $ad - bc \neq 0$, the matrix $\frac{1}{ad-bc}M$ is therefore the inverse of A.

If $ad - bc = 0$, then $AM = 0$. Suppose A is invertible: multiplying on the left by A^{-1} gives $M = 0$, so $a = b = c = d = 0$ and A is zero. But the zero matrix is not invertible ($0 \times B = 0 \neq I_2$): a contradiction. □

Property · Linear systems. A linear system of n equations in n unknowns can be written $AX = B$, where A is the matrix of coefficients, X the column of unknowns and B the column of right-hand sides. If A is invertible, the system has a unique solution: $X = A^{-1}B$.

Proof. If $AX = B$, then $A^{-1}AX = A^{-1}B$, that is $X = A^{-1}B$. Conversely, $A\left(A^{-1}B\right) = B$. □

Method · Order 3: calculator and check. For a matrix of order 3, obtain A^{-1} with a calculator or software, then check one or two entries of AA^{-1} by hand.

Transformations of the plane and sequences

Property · Matrix of a rotation. The rotation with centre O and angle θ maps the point with column X to the point with column $R_\theta X$, where

$$R_\theta = \begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta & -\sin\theta \\ \sin\theta & \cos\theta \end{pmatrix}.$$

Proof. The point $M(x, y)$ has affix $z = x + iy$, and its image has affix $e^{i\theta}z = (\cos\theta + i\sin\theta)(x + iy) = (x\cos\theta - y\sin\theta) + i(x\sin\theta + y\cos\theta)$ (chapter 3): these are the entries of $R_\theta X$. □

Method · Sequence defined by a matrix. If $X_{k+1} = AX_k$ for every k, then $X_k = A^k X_0$ (immediate induction). A sequence defined by $u_{k+2} = au_{k+1} + bu_k$ reduces to this with $X_k = \begin{pmatrix} u_{k+1} \\ u_k \end{pmatrix}$ and $A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$.